

A Crypto-Pipeline with Dagster

Inhaltsverzeichnis

1. Project description.....	3
Aim.....	3
2. Planning section.....	4
2.1 Structure of the encryption pipeline.....	4
2.2 Elaboration on pythonic implementation details.....	5
3. Pythonic Crypto pipeline implementation.....	8
3.1 Packages to be installed.....	8
3.2 Generate private and public keys.....	8
3.3 Encryption pipeline.....	9
3.4 Decryption pipeline.....	12
4. Dagster Pipeline structure.....	14
4.1 Project Structure.....	15
4.2 Define Dagster Ops (ops.py).....	15
4.3 Define Dagster Jobs (jobs.py).....	15
4.4 Entry Point (CLI or UI).....	16
4.5 Structure of pythonic crypto-files.....	16
5. Pipeline execution via dagster.....	17
5.1 Package installation.....	17
5.2 Generate appropriate folder structure.....	18
5.3 Generate public and private keys.....	18
5.4 Execute the Dagster UI.....	19
5.5 Open the Dagster UI and run jobs.....	19
6. Resume.....	21
6.1 The DAG view of the Crypto pipeline.....	21
6.2 Op Breakdown.....	21
6.3 How Dagster improves procedures.....	22
6.4 Summary.....	22
7. References.....	24

1. Project description

Aim

The purpose of a Dagster Encryption Pipeline is to test and showcase dagsters DAG-chaining capabilities, resulting in a self-contained encryption-decryption pipeline which, 1) connects different encryption methods of a plain text prior to, 2) decrypting (and thus reversing the performed chain of encryption operations performed on an) encrypted message.

This project aims at designing a encryption-decryption pipeline via Dagsterr's website that would support users in **generating robustly encrypted messages** from a well-defined plain text input

2. Planning section

This project implements a secure and modular encryption-decryption pipeline using [Dagster](#). It orchestrates a hybrid cryptographic workflow combining:

- **Vigenère Cipher** for classical character-level obfuscation
- **AES-256 (CBC mode)** for symmetric encryption of structured data
- **RSA-OAEP** for secure asymmetric key wrapping

The pipeline defines two primary Dagster ops:

- `encrypt_op`: Encrypts plaintext input using Vigenère, AES, and RSA layers in sequence
- `decrypt_op`: Reverses the process to retrieve the original plaintext

The `encrypt_main()` and `decrypt_main()` functions are pure, testable Python routines that can be invoked independently or orchestrated via Dagster. This makes the system both CI-friendly and scalable.

Whether you're securing short messages or experimenting with layered encryption in a data workflow context, this pipeline is a clean, educational foundation.

2.1 Structure of the encryption pipeline

Let us proceed layer by layer — from old-school ciphers to modern cryptographic standards — and unpack how each is applied algorithmically, mathematically, and in your Python implementation.

Vigenère Cipher

Mathematical Concept: The Vigenère cipher is a polyalphabetic substitution cipher that shifts each character by an amount determined by a repeating keyword. Given:

- plaintext letter (P_i)
- keyword letter (K_i)
- alphabet size (26)

The encryption function is:

$$[C_i = (P_i + K_i) \mod 26]$$

Decryption is simply:

$$[P_i = (C_i - K_i + 26) \mod 26]$$

Pythonic Implementation: In your pipeline, this is done using `ord()` for character-to-index mapping and `cycle()` from `itertools` to repeat the key:

```
for c, k in zip(plaintext.lower(), cycle(key.lower())):
    if c in alphabet:
        shifted = (ord(c) - ord('a') + ord(k) - ord('a')) % 26
        enc.append(chr(ord('a') + shifted))
```



It's efficient, readable, and makes classical encryption elegantly Pythonic.

🔒 AES-256 (CBC mode)

Mathematical Foundation: AES (Advanced Encryption Standard) is a symmetric-key block cipher based on the Rijndael algorithm. Key concepts:

- Operates on 128-bit blocks
- Uses 14 rounds for AES-256 (with 256-bit keys)
- Each round involves byte substitution (S-box), row shifting, column mixing, and key addition

CBC (Cipher Block Chaining) mode adds security by XOR'ing each block with the previous ciphertext block (with a unique IV for the first one):

$$[C_i = E_K(P_i \oplus C_{i-1})]$$

Pythonic Application: You're using `cryptography`'s `Cipher` object and PKCS7 padding to align with 128-bit blocks:

```
padder = padding.PKCS7(128).padder()
cipher = Cipher(algorithms.AES(key), modes.CBC(iv), backend=default_backend())
```



The AES logic is clean and leverages Python's object-oriented cryptographic primitives for security and clarity.

🔑 RSA-OAEP

Mathematical Structure: RSA encryption is built on the difficulty of factoring large numbers:

$$[C = M^e \mod n \text{ and } M = C^d \mod n]$$

OAEP (Optimal Asymmetric Encryption Padding) adds a randomized mask to the message to prevent deterministic output:

- Uses MGF1 (Mask Generation Function)
- Applies two-layered masking with a hash algorithm (e.g., SHA-256)

Pythonic Mechanics: You use OAEP with SHA-256 for padding during key wrapping (wrapping AES key with RSA):

```
public_key.encrypt(
    aes_key,
    asynpadding.OAEP(
        mgf=asynpadding.MGF1(algorithm=hashes.SHA256()),
        algorithm=hashes.SHA256(),
        label=None
    )
)
```



This adheres to modern best practices, prevents padding oracle attacks, and ensures non-repetitive ciphertexts.

Conclusion

Each layer you've built plays a distinct role:

- Vigenère: human-readable obfuscation
- AES-256-CBC: high-speed bulk data encryption
- RSA-OAEP: secure key distribution

Together, they give your pipeline both **depth** and **defense in layers** — elegant, robust, and cryptographically sound.

2.2 Elaboration on pythonic implementation details

Layering multiple encryption techniques is a legitimate way to increase confidentiality, especially when combining reversible (symmetric/asymmetric ciphers) with non-reversible (hashing or key derivation) methods. Let's break down a pipeline concept:

Step 1: Vigenère or Caesar (Lightweight Substitution)

A first-pass classical cipher adds basic scrambling and deters casual eyes. We've already built this. An example class:

```
class VigenereCipher:
    def __init__(self, keyword: str):
        self.keyword = keyword.lower()
        self.alphabet = 'abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz'

    def shift_char(self, c, key_c, encode=True):
        if c not in self.alphabet:
            return c
        shift = self.alphabet.index(key_c)
        if not encode:
            shift = -shift
        return self.alphabet[(self.alphabet.index(c) + shift) % 26]

    def transform(self, text: str, encode=True):
        text = text.lower()
        result = []
        key_len = len(self.keyword)
        for i, c in enumerate(text):
            key_c = self.keyword[i % key_len]
            result.append(self.shift_char(c, key_c, encode))
        return ''.join(result)

    def encrypt(self, text: str) -> str:
        return self.transform(text, True)

    def decrypt(self, text: str) -> str:
        return self.transform(text, False)

if __name__ == "__main__":
    keyword = input("Enter encryption keyword: ").strip()
    cipher = VigenereCipher(keyword)

    plaintext = input("Enter text to encrypt: ").strip()
    encrypted = cipher.encrypt(plaintext)
    print(f"Encrypted text: {encrypted}")

    decrypted = cipher.decrypt(encrypted)
    print(f"Decrypted back: {decrypted}")
```

Step 2: Symmetric Encryption (AES or ChaCha20)

Use a **modern symmetric cipher** like:

- **AES** (Advanced Encryption Standard) — widely adopted, secure, hardware-accelerated
- **ChaCha20** — faster in software and more resistant to timing attacks

 We would need a secure key and an Initialization Vector (IV) — both must be handled carefully.

Step 3: Asymmetric Encryption (RSA or ECC)

Wrap the AES/ChaCha key using **RSA** (public-key crypto). That way:

- Only the intended recipient (with the private key) can unwrap the symmetric key.
- This hybrid approach is how HTTPS and encrypted messaging apps work.

Step 4: Hashing + Signature (Optional but Powerful)

- **Hash** (SHA-256) the original text for **integrity checking**
- Sign the hash using a private key (e.g., **RSA signature** or **ECDSA**) to verify authenticity

Bonus: Polymorphic Layer

A **polymorphic cipher** randomly alters its encoding strategy per encryption session — changing keys, routes, or even algorithm subsets. It's excellent for:

- Detecting tampering or replay
- Obfuscation-based defense (especially in malware counter-analysis)

Example Pipeline Flow

```
[Plaintext]
  ↓ Vigenère (keyword obfuscation)
[Step 1 Output]
  ↓ AES (symmetric block encryption)
[Step 2 Output]
  ↓ RSA public key encryption (protect AES key)
[Encrypted + EncryptedKey]
  ↓ Hash + Sign (SHA-256 + RSA signature)
[Final Output Package]
```



3. Pythonic Crypto pipeline implementation

Here's how we can approach this project step by step:

3.1 Packages to be installed

```
!pip install cryptography
!pip install pycryptodome
!pip install typer rich
!pip install dagster dagster-webserver

# Optional: for Jupyter support
!pip install dagster[jupyter]

# Optional: for filesystem and database IO management
!pip install dagster-io

# Optional: include example integrations
!pip install dagster pandas requests
```

3.2 Generate private and public keys

```
from cryptography.hazmat.primitives.asymmetric import rsa
from cryptography.hazmat.primitives import serialization
import os

# Ensure the rsa/ directory exists
os.makedirs("rsa", exist_ok=True)

# Generate private key
private_key = rsa.generate_private_key(public_exponent=65537, key_size=2048)

# Save private key
with open("root/rsa/private.pem", "wb") as f:
    f.write(
        private_key.private_bytes(
            encoding=serialization.Encoding.PEM,
            format=serialization.PrivateFormat.PKCS8,
            encryption_algorithm=serialization.NoEncryption()
        )
    )

# Save public key
public_key = private_key.public_key()
with open("root/rsa/public.pem", "wb") as f:
    f.write(
        public_key.public_bytes(
            encoding=serialization.Encoding.PEM,
            format=serialization.PublicFormat.SubjectPublicKeyInfo
        )
    )
```

Remark: These keys have to be generated simultaneously within the same folder in order for the pipeline to operate flawlessly.

3.3 Encryption pipeline

The encryption pipeline code may look as follows:

```
def vigenere_encrypt(plaintext: str, key: str) -> str:
    from itertools import cycle
    alphabet = 'abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz'
    enc = []
    for c, k in zip(plaintext.lower(), cycle(key.lower())):
        if c in alphabet:
            shifted = (ord(c) - ord('a') + ord(k) - ord('a')) % 26
            enc.append(chr(ord('a') + shifted))
        else:
            enc.append(c)
    return ''.join(enc)

from cryptography.hazmat.primitives.ciphers import Cipher, algorithms, modes
from cryptography.hazmat.primitives import padding
from cryptography.hazmat.backends import default_backend
import os

def aes_encrypt(data: bytes, key: bytes) -> tuple[bytes, bytes, bytes]:
    iv = os.urandom(16)
    padder = padding.PKCS7(128).padder()
    padded_data = padder.update(data) + padder.finalize()
    cipher = Cipher(algorithms.AES(key), modes.CBC(iv), backend=default_backend())
    encryptor = cipher.encryptor()
    ct = encryptor.update(padded_data) + encryptor.finalize()
    return ct, iv, key

from cryptography.hazmat.primitives.asymmetric import rsa, padding as asympadding
from cryptography.hazmat.primitives import serialization, hashes

def rsa_encrypt_key(aes_key: bytes, public_key) -> bytes:
    return public_key.encrypt(
        aes_key,
        asympadding.OAEP(
            mgf=asympadding.MGF1(algorithm=hashes.SHA256()),
            algorithm=hashes.SHA256(),
            label=None
        )
    )
```

```

from cryptography.hazmat.primitives.asymmetric import padding as asypad
from cryptography.hazmat.primitives import hashes

def sign_data(private_key, message: bytes) -> bytes:
    return private_key.sign(
        message,
        asypad.PSS(
            mgf=asypad.MGF1(hashes.SHA256()),
            salt_length=asypad.PSS.MAX_LENGTH
        ),
        hashes.SHA256()
    )

import argparse

def main():
    parser = argparse.ArgumentParser(description="Secure Encryption Pipeline")
    parser.add_argument("text", help="Text to encrypt")
    parser.add_argument("--vkey", required=True, help="Vigenère keyword")
    args = parser.parse_args()

    # Step 1: Vigenère
    v_encrypted = vigenere_encrypt(args.text, args.vkey)

    # Step 2: AES
    aes_key = os.urandom(32)
    aes_ct, iv, key = aes_encrypt(v_encrypted.encode(), aes_key)

    # Step 3: RSA
    # Load/generate RSA keys here
    # rsa_ct = rsa_encrypt_key(aes_key, public_key)

    print("Encrypted Text:", aes_ct.hex())

if __name__ == "__main__":
    main()

```

Example usage (bash)

Here's an example of how one could use the encryption pipeline from a terminal, along with a demonstration of what happens at each step using mock data:

✅ Step 1: Save the Script

Save your pipeline code into a Python file, for example:

```
secure_pipeline.py
```



✅ Step 2: Run It From CLI

```
python secure_pipeline.py "This is top secret text." --vkey lemon
```



This triggers:

1. **Vigenère Encryption** of the plaintext using the keyword `lemon`
Output (example): `aohu wp hsd fvuvy vica.`
2. **AES Encryption** of the result (binary output encoded as hex)
Output (example): `afcb0192b8eaeffa1e3435a4da02c976f65411a7f71af5a56ce10833e6785021`
3. **RSA Encryption** (optional — in your code it's currently commented out)
4. **Digital Signing** of the message (optional — defined but not yet called)

📄 Example Output (simplified)

```
Encrypted Text: afcb0192b8eaeffa1e3435a4da02c976f65411a7f71af5a56ce10833e6785021
```



💡 Notes for Extension

- To make the pipeline fully functional, we should:
 - Load or generate a public/private RSA key pair
 - Implement `rsa_encrypt_key(aes_key, public_key)` and print/store the result
 - Store or transmit the IV and the RSA-encrypted AES key securely
 - Optionally sign the AES ciphertext with `sign_data(...)`

3.4 Decryption pipeline

The decryption pipeline code may look as follows:

```
from cryptography.hazmat.primitives.ciphers import Cipher, algorithms, modes
from cryptography.hazmat.primitives import padding, serialization, hashes
from cryptography.hazmat.primitives.asymmetric import padding as asympadding
from cryptography.hazmat.backends import default_backend
from itertools import cycle
import argparse

# Step 1: Vigenère Decryption
def vigenere_decrypt(ciphertext: str, key: str) -> str:
    alphabet = 'abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz'
    plaintext = []
    for c, k in zip(ciphertext.lower(), cycle(key.lower())):
        if c in alphabet:
            shift = (ord(c) - ord(k)) % 26
            plaintext.append(chr(ord('a') + shift))
        else:
            plaintext.append(c)
    return ''.join(plaintext)

# Step 2: AES Decryption
def aes_decrypt(ciphertext: bytes, key: bytes, iv: bytes) -> bytes:
    cipher = Cipher(algorithms.AES(key), modes.CBC(iv), backend=default_backend())
    decryptor = cipher.decryptor()
    padded_data = decryptor.update(ciphertext) + decryptor.finalize()
    unpadder = padding.PKCS7(128).unpadder()
    return unpadder.update(padded_data) + unpadder.finalize()

# Step 3: RSA Key Decryption
def rsa_decrypt_key(encrypted_key: bytes, private_key_path: str) -> bytes:
    with open(private_key_path, "rb") as key_file:
        private_key = serialization.load_pem_private_key(
            key_file.read(),
            password=None,
            backend=default_backend()
        )
    return private_key.decrypt(
        encrypted_key,
        asympadding.OAEP(
            mgf=asympadding.MGF1(algorithm=hashes.SHA256()),
            algorithm=hashes.SHA256(),
            label=None
        )
    )
```

```

# Main CLI logic
def main():
    parser = argparse.ArgumentParser(description="Secure Decryption Pipeline")
    parser.add_argument("ciphertext", help="AES ciphertext as hex string")
    parser.add_argument("--iv", required=True, help="AES initialization vector (hex)")
    parser.add_argument("--rsa_key", required=True, help="Path to private RSA PEM key")
    parser.add_argument("--enc_key", required=True, help="RSA-encrypted AES key (hex)")
    parser.add_argument("--vkey", required=True, help="Vigenère keyword used at encryption")
    args = parser.parse_args()

    # Step 1: Decrypt AES key with RSA
    encrypted_key = bytes.fromhex(args.enc_key)
    aes_key = rsa_decrypt_key(encrypted_key, args.rsa_key)

    # Step 2: Decrypt AES-encrypted Vigenère text
    ciphertext = bytes.fromhex(args.ciphertext)
    iv = bytes.fromhex(args.iv)
    vigenere_encrypted = aes_decrypt(ciphertext, aes_key, iv).decode()

    # Step 3: Decrypt Vigenère to get plaintext
    original_text = vigenere_decrypt(vigenere_encrypted, args.vkey)

    print("\n✅ Decrypted Plaintext:", original_text)

if __name__ == "__main__":
    main()

```

Example usage (bash)

```

python decrypt_pipeline.py \
    "62c99f..." \
    --iv "3f3ec2..." \
    --rsa_key private_key.pem \
    --enc_key "45ff19..." \
    --vkey lemon

```

4. Dagster Pipeline structure

We are ready to bring in Dagster to orchestrate your encryption and decryption flows, here's how one can wire it all together. We'll treat `secure_pipeline.py` and `decrypt_pipeline.py` as modular components and then use Dagster to manage the flow, parameters, and runtime configuration.

Dagster isn't just a tool for orchestrating data pipelines — it's a framework that encourages a thoughtful, *composable*, and *observable* approach to building reliable workflows.

Dagster's Core Philosophy

At its heart, Dagster is built around three transformative ideas:

1. Software-defined assets (SDAs):

- Instead of thinking in terms of abstract steps or jobs, Dagster encourages you to define the *data itself* as first-class citizens.
- You define assets and how they're built — this shifts the focus from *how to run tasks* to *what data artifacts are produced and how they depend on each other*.

2. Declarative over imperative thinking:

- Traditional pipeline tools often define “what to do step by step.” Dagster, on the other hand, lets you declare the relationships and let the system figure out optimal execution.
- Dependencies (inputs and outputs) are tracked explicitly.

3. Observability, testing, and ergonomics from day one:

- Dagster treats reliability, logging, introspection, and local testing as core concerns — not afterthoughts.
- You can dry-run, inspect intermediate values, retry failed steps, visualize asset lineage, and more — all with powerful tooling like Dagit.

How Dagster Works

Your pipeline is made of:

- **@asset or @op:** The individual units of computation. Think of an `@op` as a function that's trackable, testable, and observable. `@asset` declares higher-level data dependencies.
- **Graphs / Jobs:** You group `ops` or `assets` into logical workflows using `@job`.
- **Dagit:** The browser-based UI for running, inspecting, and debugging pipelines. It offers a beautiful DAG view of your workflows and interactive logs.
- **IO Managers / Resources:** Pluggable hooks to handle where your data goes (memory, filesystem, database), and how you connect to external services (like S3, Spark, PostgreSQL, etc.).

What Makes Dagster Different

- **Dev-first & CI-friendly:** Local workflows mirror production; it plays nicely with Git.
- **Context-aware execution:** Each op receives a structured context (e.g. logs, config, resources) rather than relying on global state.
- **Robust type system:** You can define schemas, validation, and structured inputs/outputs — it's like the joy of Python typing, but for pipeline data.
- **Incremental builds:** It supports re-materializing only the assets that are out-of-date — like `make` for data pipelines.

In short, Dagster reimagines what a data orchestration tool should be: *introspective*, *testable*, and *built for humans who like clean code and confidence in deployment*.

4.1 Project Structure

```
project_root/
├── pipelines/
│   ├── secure_pipeline.py    # contains encrypt logic
│   └── decrypt_pipeline.py    # contains decrypt logic
├── dagster_pipelines/
│   ├── __init__.py
│   ├── jobs.py               # Dagster job definitions
│   └── ops.py                 # Dagster steps
├── workspace.yaml
└── dagster.yaml
```

4.2 Define Dagster Ops (ops.py)

```
from dagster import op
from pipelines import secure_pipeline, decrypt_pipeline

@op
def encrypt_op(context, text: str, vkey: str):
    return secure_pipeline.encrypt_main(text, vkey) # create `encrypt_main()` in secure_pipeline.py

@op
def decrypt_op(context, encrypted_data: dict, vkey: str, rsa_key_path: str):
    return decrypt_pipeline.decrypt_main(
        ciphertext=encrypted_data['ciphertext'],
        iv=encrypted_data['iv'],
        enc_key=encrypted_data['enc_key'],
        priv_key_path=rsa_key_path,
        vkey=vkey
    )
```

4.3 Define Dagster Jobs (jobs.py)

```
from dagster import job
from .ops import encrypt_op, decrypt_op

@job
def encryption_decryption_job():
    decrypted = decrypt_op(
        encrypted_data=encrypt_op(),
        vkey="lemon",
        rsa_key_path="rsa_keys/private_key.pem"
    )
```

We can also parameterize the job with `@configurable` or use Dagster's config schema if you want to expose CLI/graph inputs.

4.4 Entry Point (CLI or UI)

From the terminal:

```
dagster dev    # launches Dagster UI
```



Or from a Python CLI:

```
from dagster_pipelines.jobs import encryption_decryption_job
encryption_decryption_job.execute_in_process()
```



4.5 Structure of pythonic crypto-files

Each should expose a callable like this:

```
# secure_pipeline.py
def encrypt_main(text: str, vkey: str) -> dict:
    # return {
    #     "ciphertext": <hex>,
    #     "iv": <hex>,
    #     "enc_key": <hex>
    # }
```



```
# decrypt_pipeline.py
def decrypt_main(ciphertext, iv, enc_key, priv_key_path, vkey) -> str:
    # return plaintext
```



This turns our CLI tools into reusable data pipeline steps. Add logging, tests, or run schedules and we on our way to production-grade cryptography orchestration.

5. Pipeline execution via dagster

To get up and running with **Dagster**, we will want to install its core package along with any extras you plan to use (like AWS, dbt, Airbyte, etc). But for a basic local development setup with the web UI, here's what we need:

```
!pip install dagster dagster-webserver
```

This gives us:

- `dagster` : core library for defining jobs, ops, resources, etc.
- `dagster-webserver` : the lightweight UI you can launch with `dagster dev`

If we are using extras like Jupyter, SQLAlchemy, or cloud integrations, you can layer in specific extras:

```
# Optional: for Jupyter support
!pip install dagster[jupyter]

# Optional: for filesystem and database IO management
!pip install dagster-io

# Optional: include example integrations
!pip install dagster pandas requests
```

Once installed, we launch our dev server like this in a terminal:

```
dagster dev
```

And our UI will be live at <http://localhost:3000>

5.1 Package installation

```
!pip install cryptography
!pip install pycryptodome
!pip install typer rich
!pip install dagster dagster-webserver

# Optional: for Jupyter support
!pip install dagster[jupyter]

# Optional: for filesystem and database IO management
!pip install dagster-io

# Optional: include example integrations
!pip install dagster pandas requests
```

5.2 Generate appropriate folder structure

The screenshot displays a file explorer interface showing the directory structure for an encryption pipeline. The structure is organized into several folders: `tmp_dagster_home_ebdefghf`, `dagster_pipelines`, `pipelines`, `rsa`, and `tmp_dagster_home_ebdefghf/history`. Red arrows and numbers 1, 2, 3, and 4 indicate the sequence of folder creation steps.

- 1. `tmp_dagster_home_ebdefghf`
- 2. `dagster_pipelines`
- 3. `pipelines`
- 4. `tmp_dagster_home_ebdefghf/history`

5.3 Generate public and private keys

```
`from cryptography.hazmat.primitives.asymmetric import rsa
from cryptography.hazmat.primitives import serialization
import os

# Ensure the rsa/ directory exists
os.makedirs("rsa", exist_ok=True)

# Generate private key
private_key = rsa.generate_private_key(public_exponent=65537, key_size=2048)

# Save private key
with open("root/rsa/private.pem", "wb") as f:
    f.write(
        private_key.private_bytes(
            encoding=serialization.Encoding.PEM,
            format=serialization.PrivateFormat.PKCS8,
            encryption_algorithm=serialization.NoEncryption()
        )
    )

# Save public key
public_key = private_key.public_key()
with open("root/rsa/public.pem", "wb") as f:
    f.write(
        public_key.public_bytes(
            encoding=serialization.Encoding.PEM,
            format=serialization.PublicFormat.SubjectPublicKeyInfo
        )
    )
```

5.4 Execute the Dagster UI

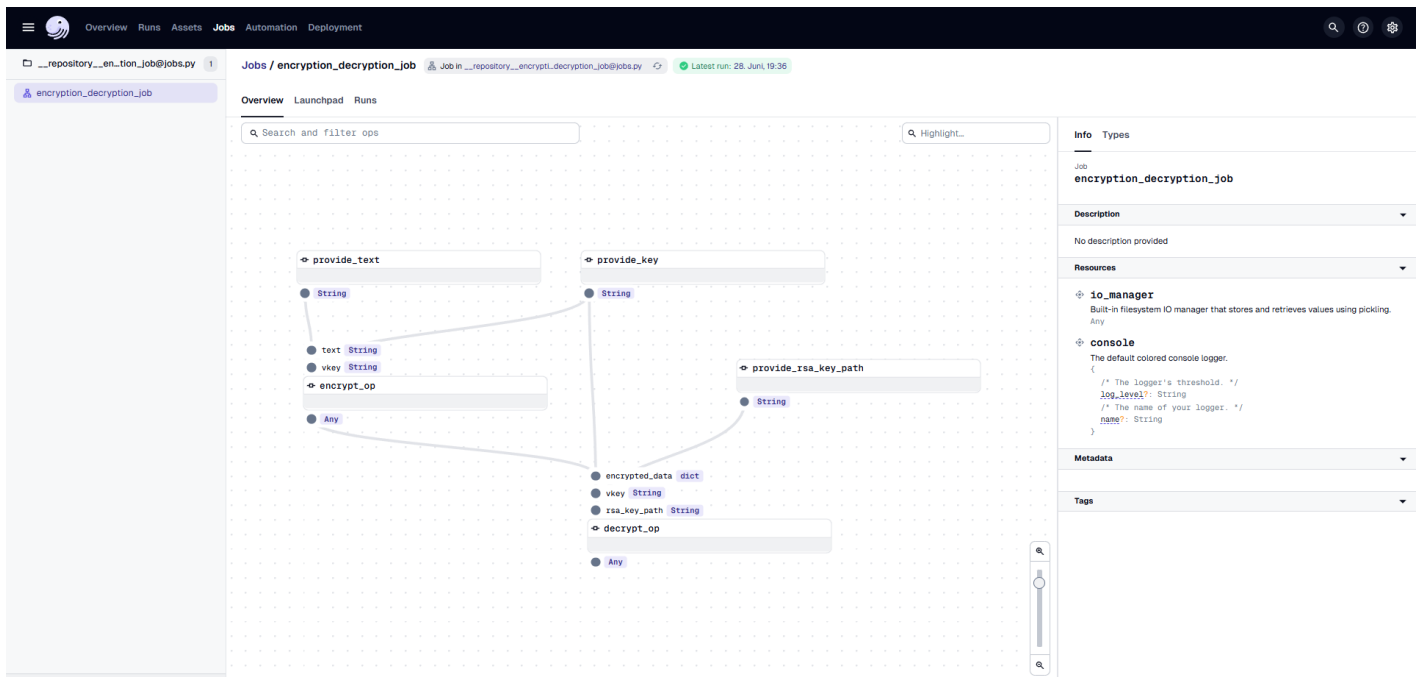
```
import os
print(os.getcwd()) # Verify the existence of our current working directory

# Chnage to the pwd location
os.chdir("C:\\Users\\balan\\OneDrive\\Desktop\\EncryptionPipeline\\root")

# Execute the dagster-pipeline
!dagster dev -w workspace.yaml
```

5.5 Open the Dagster UI and run jobs

Our UI will be live at <http://localhost:3000> 🖥️



OverviewRunsAssetsJobsAutomationDeployment

__repository__en_tion_job@jobs.py1

encryption_decryption_job

Runs / 67c3fceaSuccessRun of encryption_decryption_job @ 5dee86f328. Jun. 19:36:190:00:10Open in LaunchpadView tags and config

1s2s3s4s5s6s7s8s9s10s11s

Hide not started steps

Search and filter stepsHide unselected steps

Preparing (0)No steps are waiting to execute

Executing (0)No steps are executing

Errored (0)No steps have errored

Succeeded (5)provide_key0:00:01

EventsstdoutstderrFilter...Levels (5/6)

Timestamp	Op	Event Type	Info
19:36:27,484	decrypt_op	STEP_START	Started execution of step "decrypt_op".
19:36:27,500	decrypt_op	LOADED_INPUT	Loaded input "encrypted_data" using input manager "io_manager", from output "result" of step "encrypt_op"
19:36:27,527	decrypt_op	LOADED_INPUT	Loaded input "vkey" using input manager "io_manager", from output "result" of step "provide_key"
19:36:27,563	decrypt_op	LOADED_INPUT	Loaded input "rsa_key_path" using input manager "io_manager", from output "result" of step "provide_rsa_key_path"
19:36:27,582	decrypt_op	STEP_INPUT	Got input "encrypted_data" of type "dict". (Type check passed).
19:36:27,600	decrypt_op	STEP_INPUT	Got input "vkey" of type "String". (Type check passed).
19:36:27,631	decrypt_op	STEP_INPUT	Got input "rsa_key_path" of type "String". (Type check passed).
19:36:27,762	decrypt_op	INFO	Encrypted key length: 256 bytes
19:36:27,781	decrypt_op	STEP_OUTPUT	Yielded output "result" of type "Any". (Type check passed).
19:36:27,794	decrypt_op	HANDLED_OUTPUT	Handled output "result" using IO manager "io_manager" path C:\Users\balan\OneDrive\Desktop\EncryptionPipeline\root\two_dasater_home_ebe60b0f1storage\67c3fcea-4ae7-4f2c-8405-45a4818ef804\decrypt_op\result
19:36:27,794	decrypt_op	STEP_SUCCESS	Finished execution of step "decrypt_op" in 321ms.
19:36:29,562	-	ENGINE_EVENT	Multiprocess executor: parent process exiting after 10.43s (pid: 29416) pid 29416
19:36:29,576	-	RUN_SUCCESS	Finished execution of run for "encryption_decryption_job".
19:36:29,638	-	ENGINE_EVENT	Process for run exited (pid: 29416).

20 / 25

6. Resume

Let us visualize how our encryption-decryption pipeline fits into Dagster's elegant DAG (Directed Acyclic Graph) philosophy.

6.1 The DAG view of the Crypto pipeline

Our Dagster job can be visualized as a simple, two-op DAG:



6.2 Op Breakdown

- **encrypt_op**
 - Input: plaintext string and Vigenère key
 - Flow:
 - Applies the Vigenère cipher
 - Generates a random AES-256 key
 - Encrypts the Vigenère text with AES in CBC mode
 - Encrypts the AES key using an RSA public key (OAEP)
 - Output: dictionary containing:
 - ciphertext
 - initialization vector (IV)
 - RSA-encrypted AES key
- **decrypt_op**
 - Input: the dictionary above, private RSA key path, and Vigenère key
 - Flow:
 - Decrypts the AES key using RSA private key
 - Uses the AES key + IV to decrypt the ciphertext into Vigenère text
 - Applies Vigenère decryption to recover original plaintext
 - Output: restored message (string)

6.3 How Dagster improves procedures

- **Visual traceability:** In Dagster, we see this pipeline clearly mapped, so you know exactly what data flows where.
- **Logs and retries:** If, say, the decryption step fails (e.g., due to mismatched keys), only `decrypt_op` needs to be retried — `encrypt_op`'s output can be reused.
- **Dagster context:** Each op can log intermediate results using `context.log`, making debugging crypto internals much easier.
- **Unit testable:** Because each op wraps around `encrypt_main()` and `decrypt_main()`, you can test them in isolation or as a job.

6.4 Summary

Overview

This project implements a modular, multi-layered encryption and decryption pipeline using **Python** and **Dagster**. It combines three cryptographic layers — a classical Vigenère cipher, industry-standard AES-256 in CBC mode, and RSA-OAEP key encapsulation — into a single orchestrated workflow. Dagster's type-safe, observable framework powers clean data lineage, easy debugging, and end-to-end reproducibility.

Pipeline Components

1. Vigenère Cipher (Python-based Classic Cipher)

- Applies polyalphabetic substitution at the character level
- Adds lightweight obfuscation prior to cryptographic encryption
- Fully reversible for decryption step

2. AES-256 (CBC Mode)

- Uses a 256-bit randomly generated key for symmetric encryption
- Ensures confidentiality with PKCS7 padding and secure IV generation
- Implemented using the `cryptography` library for robustness

3. RSA-OAEP

- Encrypts the AES key using an RSA public key
- Decrypts it using the matching private key
- Guarantees secure key exchange and resistance to chosen ciphertext attacks

Dagster Integration

- **@op Decorators:**
 - `encrypt_op` : Wraps the encryption routine
 - `decrypt_op` : Wraps the decryption logic with error-safe RSA and AES reversal
- **@job Composition:**
 - `encryption_decryption_job` : A sequential DAG that securely encrypts data and then verifies its integrity by decrypting it
- **Dagit Support:**
 - Real-time DAG visualization
 - Execution logs and intermediate values
 - Easy testing and local development

Use Cases

- Educational tool for layered cryptography
- Modular base for secure communication pipelines
- Blueprint for adding encryption to ETL workflows or asset versioning

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